
73rd Ulster Pipe Band Championships

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73rd Ulster Pipe Band Championships

Saturday 1 August 2026

Bangor | 11am - 6pm

Enjoy an impressive display of sight and sound, as talented pipe bands and drum major groups come together competing for coveted awards.

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Part of Bangor Vibes, 1 – 2 August, find out more about the weekend [here](#). On Saturday 1 August, why not travel on the dedicated shuttle, which will run between Balloo Park & Ride and Bangor City Centre to enjoy the entertainment on offer throughout Bangor. (This is a free service, with no tickets required, which will operate on a first come first served basis). [Find out more about the shuttle service.](#)

The Ulster Championships brings together bands, families and supporters from all over for what is one of our biggest annual events, and will see bands and drum majors compete for the prestigious 'Ulster Champion' title.

Accessible parking will be available in the Gransha Road car park (by the cricket pitch), with additional overflow accessible parking available from Broadway. Please note that spaces are limited and available on a pre-bookable basis only through the Pipe Band website - <https://rspbani.org/>

For full event information please visit the dedicated **Ulster Championships event page**: rspbani.org/event/ulster26 which includes details on...

- **Band Guidance:** including, Band Gazebos | Practice/Tuning | Finale | End of Day Parade
- **Parking:** including, General Parking | Accessible Parking (pre-booking required) | Band Coach Parking (pre-booking required) | Motorhomes
- **General Information:** including, Programmes | Food/Drink | Barbeques | Toilet Facilities | First Aid | Lost Persons | Drones | Litter | Dogs | Safeguarding | Unacceptable Behaviour | Recording and Photographs

For any general event queries, please email contests@rspbani.org.

For specific Band/Drum Major queries, please email secretary@rspbani.org.

This event run under RSPBANI Local Rules. If you have any queries, please e-mail secretary@rspbani.org.

Visitor Information

Whilst visiting the Pipe Bands event, call by our Visitor Information Point located nearby the hot food trucks where our staff will be happy to help guide you through your day, or offer tips on how to make even more of your visit.

Follow The Royal Scottish Pipe Band Association Northern Ireland Branch (RSPBANI), on [Facebook](#), you can email info@rspbani.org, or call +44 (0)28 9267 0445.

Keep up to date

Sign up to our e-newsletter and follow the Visit Ards and North Down social channels...

[Sign up](#) | [Facebook](#) | [Instagram](#)

Please note

- This event is a no drone zone. Only official event drones authorised by the event organisers are permitted

- This event is being photographed/filmed. Images may be used in Ards and North Down Borough Council promotional material. If you do not want your image to be used, please inform our event staff

Make a Break of it and Stay a While

Stay a while and take a break on our shores. Relax in the beauty of this place, offering everything from 5 star luxury to cosy guest houses or unique self-catering options, maybe camping and caravanning is more your thing, let us help you plan your perfect getaway.

Find out more in our [Plan Your Trip](#) section.

Sustainability

Ards and North Down Borough Council is committed to reducing our carbon footprint. We encourage visitors to travel via public transport, there are fresh water stations on site bring along refillable water bottles, reusable bags to pick up goodies at the event and please dispose rubbish in the correct bins when on-site.

Read more about our [Roadmap to Sustainability](#) and [Recycling at Council-run Events](#) in Ards and North Down.

Please enjoy the day responsibly and help us protect, respect and enjoy our place together by following [The Good Visitor Promise](#).

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